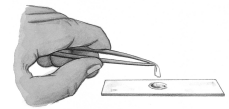


Preparing a stained wet mount

Student: Class:

Jumbled steps

1. The following diagrams show the steps used to prepare a wet mount of onion epidermis, but the order has been jumbled. Place the code letters in the correct sequence.



- A. Lower a coverslip over the onion skin and water droplet.
 B. Peel a section of onion epidermis.
 C. Soak up excess water with a tissue.
 D. Add a drop of water to a microscope slide.
 E. Place onion skin in drop of water on the slide.

Correct sequence:

Staining cells

2. It is much easier to see the internal structure of cells by staining the tissue. The following materials are available to prepare a stained wet mount of onion epidermis.

dropping bottle of methylene blue or other similar stain, microscope, microscope slide, coverslip, small section of a peeled onion, forceps, toothpick, dropping bottle of water

- (a) Write a method for your investigation.

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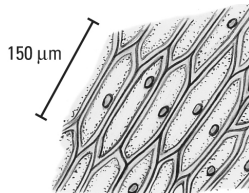
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- (b) The drawing below left was made of the stained onion epidermal tissue.



- (i) The nucleus and cell walls take up the methylene blue stain. Use a blue pencil to colour these components in the drawing.

- (ii) Use the scale to estimate the greatest width of a cell.

- (iii) The experiment was repeated with iodine stain, which strongly stains starch grains a deep blue-black colour. Use coloured pencils to colour the starch grains, which are scattered in the cytoplasm in the cells at the right.

